

Discovery Ranking Rubric v1

This rubric does not prescribe a specific algorithm. It defines the relative value of different types of discoveries and should inform future ranking, filtering, and eligibility decisions.

Highest Priority

These discoveries most strongly align with Streetlit's purpose.

- Hidden stories
- Human and community stories
- Visible remnants of an earlier use or era
- Discoveries that explain why a place or neighborhood looks the way it does today
- Ordinary places connected to larger historical, cultural, social, or economic patterns
- Discoveries that reveal an invisible layer of the city

Examples:

- Hidden Pullman train car inside a former office building
- Former speakeasy entrance
- Windermere's role in tenant-rights history
- Oregon Diner preserving the footprint of Stonehouse Lane

Medium-High Priority

Strong discoveries that deepen understanding of a place.

- Neighborhood context
- Adaptive reuse
- Local institutions with meaningful civic or social roles
- Architectural details that meaningfully change perception
- Discoveries that reveal how people once lived, worked, traveled, learned, or gathered

Examples:

- Streetcar-suburb development
- Public-health influences on school design
- Commercial districts created to serve a growing neighborhood

Medium Priority

Useful discoveries that may not be deeply historical but still reward attention.

- Visually striking architecture with meaningful context
- Distinctive physical features with explanatory context
- Contextual discoveries in areas with few higher-priority opportunities

Examples:

- The McGraw-Hill Building's Art Deco design and distinctive terra-cotta facade
- An unusual architectural style that helps explain a period of development

Low Priority / Manual Exploration

Information that may be useful to curious users but generally should not trigger automatic narration.

- Generic descriptions
- Basic place information
- Category-level information
- Generic business functions

Examples:

- School
- Bank
- Office building
- Restaurant
- Place of worship

Suppress from Auto-Surface

The following do not meaningfully contribute to discovery and should generally be suppressed from automatic narration.

- Metadata-only content
- Facts obvious from visual observation
- Generic business descriptions
- Repeated contextual themes already established during the walk
- Generic chain businesses with no meaningful story
- Placeholder language ("notable place," "local institution," etc.) unsupported by actual context
- Raw category labels presented as discoveries

Examples:

- “This is a bank.”
- “This building has four stories.”
- “It serves local students.”
- “A notable place in this area.”

Tie-Breaking Principle

When choosing between two discoveries:

Prefer the discovery that creates the larger change in the user’s understanding of a place.

An ordinary place with an extraordinary story should generally outrank an extraordinary-looking place with no meaningful story.